

House Najil

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"LOYAL IS THE HOUND TO THE MASTER"

Quick Facts

Status: Knight/Dame

Origin: Aicruae (Western)

Founded: 8,704 BR

Founder: Asa Najil (née Paneta)

House Name Meaning: Bold, Brave and True

Seat: The Aoner, Western Aicruae (one of three towns in Western Aicruae)

Faction: Divine Faction

Spirit Animal: White Dog (Hound)

Colors: Violet-Purple (Devotion & Noble Spirit) & Hunter Green (Loyalty & Growth)

Wealth: 72,000 Rern

Military: Limited (knight family, lowest rank of nobility; members traditionally serve as knights to the crown)

Religion: Leneyez

Theme Song: "Meet Me On The Battlefield" by SVRCINA

Status By Era

Pre-Empire Era: Knight/Dame. The lowest rank of nobility, but wealthier than their status would suggest thanks to the inherited Paneta fortune.

Solis's Era: Eradicated. After the events of the civil war, House Najil was destroyed for conspiring with the twins to usurp the throne from Solis. They lost their noble status and were banished from Aicruae.

Crandona's Era: [TBD]

Minara's Era: [TBD]

Why They Matter

House Najil was built on a defiant act: a bastard daughter, rejected by her own blood, buying her way into the noble class and swearing herself as a knight to the king. From the start, Najil was a house that had to fight for its place at the table. They were never fully accepted by high society, never granted the kind of power or influence that came with higher titles. And yet they persisted, married into the right families, and even placed one of their own on the throne as queen.

Their motto says it all, and so does how they died. "Loyal is the hound to the master." For generations, that loyalty defined them. Then they sided with the twins against Solis, and it destroyed them. A house born from stubbornness and survival, wiped out by a single act of disloyalty to the very crown they'd sworn to serve.

Heraldry

The Crest: The House Najil crest is divided per fess (horizontally across the middle), with a rich violet-purple field above and a deep hunter green below. The division between the two fields follows an undulating, hill-like line that mimics rolling terrain. In the green lower field sits a cream-colored hound in a dignified seated position, its posture alert and attentive, long ears hanging, gaze steady. Surrounding the dog on both sides are oak branches bearing green leaves and golden acorns. Two branches with acorns hang from above in the purple field, and more acorn-laden branches frame the hound below.

Symbolism:

The cream-colored hound is the house itself. Seated. Watching. Waiting for a command. Asa Najil, nicknamed "the Lady of the Garden," built this house from a bastard's inheritance and a purchased title, and the first thing she did was swear herself as a knight to the king. She chose the role of the loyal servant because she knew she'd never be accepted as an equal. A hound doesn't sit at the table. A hound sits at the master's feet and earns its place by being useful, by being faithful, by being ready when called. That was the Najil strategy for generations. Stay loyal. Stay useful. Stay alive.

And it worked. Silaria Najil became a champion coveted for beauty and strength. Queen Cecea married King Sayero and connected the house directly to the royal line. Matasen married into House Aedria and produced nine heirs. The hound kept sitting. The hound kept being loyal. Until Solis's Era, when House Najil sided with

the twins against the emperor and learned exactly what happens when a hound turns on its master. They were eradicated. Stripped of their title. Banished from Aicruae entirely.

The garden setting honors Asa's nickname. The hound doesn't sit on a battlefield or in a throne room. It sits in a garden, surrounded by growing things, because Asa built this house the way you build a garden. You plant it. You tend it. You wait. The rolling green hills behind the hound look like Western Aicruae, like the territory around the Aoner where the Najils made their home. It's quiet land. Unassuming. Just like the family that lived there.

The oak branches and golden acorns are about what small things can become. An acorn is nothing. It fits in your hand. But given time, given the right soil, it becomes something nobody can move. Asa was an acorn. A bastard daughter rejected by House Paneta, inheriting half a fortune she was never supposed to touch. She planted herself in that soil and grew into something the Paneta family never could have predicted. Her daughter Silaria was an acorn that became a warrior legend. Queen Cecea was an acorn that became a queen. The acorns on the crest say: don't underestimate the small thing. It'll outgrow you.

But acorns can also rot. Nilinlo ran away to the Cidet at nine and got kicked out for drinking. Basiol watched his wife's affair like entertainment and went mad when she died. The same family that produced champion warriors and a queen also produced scandal after scandal. The oaks grew twisted sometimes.

The violet-purple field is devotion and noble spirit. House Najil follows Leneyez, the faith that requires sacrifice to maintain the physical and spiritual well-being of the gods. Devotion is the entire identity of a Leneyez believer. You give something up. You offer your best. That's what the Najils did for centuries. They gave their knights to the crown, gave their daughters to royal marriages, gave their loyalty without reservation. Purple also carries a claim to nobility that House Najil always had to fight for. They were knights. The lowest rank. But purple says they saw themselves as something more. Asa bought the title, but she believed she deserved it.

The hunter green field is loyalty and the natural world. Green for the garden. Green for growth. Green for the Western Aicruaen countryside where this family put roots down and held on for generations despite never being fully accepted by

high society. The green is stubborn. It's the color of something that keeps growing whether anyone wants it to or not. That was House Najil.

House Colors: Violet-Purple and Hunter Green. Purple for devotion, noble spirit, and the Leneyez faith that demands sacrifice. Green for loyalty, growth, and the stubborn refusal to stop growing even when nobody thinks you belong.

Motto: "Loyal is the hound to the master." The motto is the proudest and saddest thing about House Najil all at once. It's what Asa swore when she knelt before the king and became a knight. It's what every Najil after her lived by. Silaria won her tournaments for the crown. Cecea married into the royal family. Dela served as a knight to the very king whom she might have had every right to turn against. The hound was loyal. Always.

And then it wasn't. When it counted most, when the civil war split the kingdom between Solis and the twins, House Najil picked the wrong master. They conspired against the throne they'd sworn to serve and lost everything. Their title. Their land. Their name. The motto survived longer than the family did. That's the tragedy of it. "Loyal is the hound to the master" is carved into a crest that belongs to a house that no longer exists because it forgot the one thing it promised never to forget.

Power & Influence

Source of Power

Little to no actual political influence due to their knight rank, the lowest tier of nobility.

Internal Power Structure

Traditional patriarchal.

Military Forces

Limited. As a knight family, House Najil is not particularly powerful in terms of military strength. However, being a family of knights, its members possess warrior-like qualities. Najil members traditionally serve as knights to the crown.

Lands & Income

Seat: The Aoner in Western Aicruae (one of three towns in Western Aicruae).

Wealth: 72,000 Rern, inherited from the Paneta fortune. While they hold the lowest rank of nobility, they have maintained that fortune over the years.

Key industries: [TBD]

Alliances & Rivalries

Allied Houses

House Arvento, Decent relationship established through a marriage alliance between Halcai Arvento and Alema Najil.

House Mena, Distant relatives through Asa Najil's father's lineage. The union of Lady Vaseiula Mena and Ser Winsafantero Paneta produced Zacareneal Paneta, who was Asa Najil's father. This gives House Najil distant royal blood connections.

House Aedria, Marriage alliance through Lady Erhen Aedria marrying Matasen Najil, a union that blessed the house with nine heirs.

Royal Connections

House Patton (Royal Family): Queen Cecea Sanitte Patton (8,618 BR - 8,545 BR) came from House Najil and married King Sayero Walica Patton, producing Prince Benjamin Lawrence Patton and Princess Toavaliae Javivata Patton. This marriage connected House Najil directly to the royal line and greatly elevated the house's prestige.

Rival Houses

[TBD]

House Culture

Religion

Leneyez. The sub-religion of Leneyez believes in sacrificing both people and farm life to the two sets of gods during monthly prayers and festivals. Believers maintain both the physical and spiritual well-being of the gods through sacrifice.

Traditions

[TBD]

Values

[TBD]

Reputation

[TBD]

History

Founding (8,704 BR)

House Najil was created when Asa Paneta used her inherited wealth to buy herself a noble title, changing her name to Asa Najil. Born as the bastard daughter of Zacareneal Paneta, Asa was never accepted by the Paneta family, who boasted royal blood connections. When Zacareneal died at age 26, he left half the family fortune to Asa in his will, crippling the legitimate Paneta family. Asa used this inheritance to purchase a noble title and swore herself as a knight to the king, knowing she would never be fully accepted by high society.

Rise to Power

[TBD]

Major Achievements

[TBD]

Major Disgraces

House Najil conspired with the twins to usurp the throne from Solis. After the civil war, the house was eradicated, losing their noble status and being banished from Aicruae entirely.

Role in Key Events

[TBD]

Notable Members

Listed chronologically, from the house's founder to its later generations.

Asa Najil (8,742 BR – 8,683 BR)

Founder of House Najil | "The Lady of the Garden"

Name meaning: New Dawn

Bastard daughter of Zacareneal Paneta, born to Zacareneal's mistress, Minguna. Asa was never accepted by the noble House Paneta. When her father Zacareneal died at age 26 without a legitimate heir, he left half the Paneta fortune to her in his will. She used the inheritance to buy herself a noble title, because the Paneta family would never accept a bastard. She swore herself as a knight to the king, founding House Najil in 8,704 BR. Despite her title, she was never fully accepted by noble society. She died at 59.

Silaria Najil (8,713 BR – 8,613 BR)

Asa's Only Heir

Name meaning: Bottom of the Lake

A famous warrior and champion from a young age. Silaria was also a renowned beauty who attracted suitors from all over the world, "coveted for beauty and strength." She married at age 25 to a man sponsored by her mother, "breaking the heart of noblemen across the world." She won countless tournaments and battles over the course of her lifetime. She died at 100.

Queen Cecea Sanitte Patton (8,618 BR – 8,545 BR)

The Royal Connection

Name meaning: Little Crow

From House Najil. Married King Sayero Walica Patton, becoming queen. Mother of Prince Benjamin Lawrence Patton and Princess Toavaliae Javivata Patton. This marriage connected House Najil directly to the royal line and was the most significant elevation of the house's prestige in its history. She died at 73.

Nilinlo Najil (8,572 BR – 8,546 BR)

"The Scandal"

Name meaning: A Sequence of Light

Ran away to the Cidet at age 9. Ten years later, he was kicked out for drinking liquor. Not much is known about him due to his time spent away from high society. His story caused a major scandal for the house. He fathered only one illegitimate heir before his death at 26.

Dela Najil (8,569 BR – 8,506 BR)

"The Crescent Moon"

Name meaning: Half of a Day

Rumored lover of Princess Toavaliae Javivata Patton. The two were often seen quite intimate at court. Princess Toavaliae reportedly wanted to name her first son (the crown prince) after Dela.

The love story was a tragic one. Princess Toavaliae was forced to marry her brother, King Benjamin Lawrence Patton I, while Dela had to become a knight loyal to serving the King, her lover's abuser. Dela married Ser Edesfar Kasie despite her true love. She died at 63.

Matasen Najil (8,534 BR – 8,465 BR)

Son of Dela

Name meaning: Morning of Spring

Born to conflicting parents, Dela Najil and Ser Edesfar Kasie. His childhood was an unhappy one; his parents lived apart, constantly bouncing him between them. He grew up meek and socially awkward. "Women would run away from him screaming and men would poke at his weak nature." He struggled to find a wife well into his thirties, a social anomaly for a nobleman of that era.

Eventually he married Lady Erhen Aedria, who fell in love with him. Their union blessed House Najil with nine heirs. He died at 69.

Basiol Najil (8,498 BR – 8,439 BR)

Son of Matasen

Name meaning: Rising Tree

First child and son of Matasen Najil and Lady Erhen Aedria. Despite growing up in a household where his parents genuinely loved each other, Basiol developed a twisted understanding of love. He was a voyeuristic and controlling husband. He secretly watched his wife's affair, only intervening when they planned to run away together. "He thought he owned his wife and that his wife was simply a tool for him."

He wanted his wife to have nine children, like his mother, but she died after four. After her death, he refused to eat or drink and had delusions that she was still alive. He died at 59.

Strengths & Weaknesses

Known For

[TBD]

What They Lack

[TBD]

Vulnerabilities

[TBD]

Role in Narrative

Book Appearances: [TBD]

Plot Significance: [TBD]

Key Members in Story: [TBD]

Cross-References

House Patton, House Arvento, House Mena, House Aedria, House Paneta, King Sayero Walica Patton, Queen Cecea Sanitte Patton, Prince Benjamin Lawrence Patton, Princess Toavaliae Javivata Patton, King Benjamin Lawrence Patton I, Ser Edesfar Kasie, Lady Erhen Aedria, Halcai Arvento, Alema Najil, Lady Vaseiula Mena, Ser Winsafantero Paneta, Zacareneal Paneta, Minguna, Western Aicruae,

The Aoner, The Cidet, Leneyez (Religion), Divine Faction, Aicruan Civil War, Rern (Currency)

Keywords

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